For the body building purpose, the major nutrients are proteins and minerals. Foods rich in protein are called body building foods. Milk, meat, egg and fish are rich in proteins of high quality due to the presence of essential amino acids. Pulses and nuts are good sources of protein but the protein is not of good quality because they lack some of the essential amino acids which are rich in cereals.

c) Regulatory and protective function of foods

Food Sources: Vegetables and fruits.

These foods regulate the activities of the body such as beating of the heart, maintenance of body temperature, muscle contraction, control of water balance, clotting of blood, removal of waste products from the body, etc.

Our body uses water in all its cells, organs and tissues to help regulate its temperature and maintain other bodily functions. Our body loses water through breathing, sweating and digestion, It is important to rehydrate our body by drinking fluids and eating foods that contain water.

Dietary fibers found mainly in fruits and vegetables, wholegrains and legumes provide health benefits such as relieving constipation, maintaining healthy weight lowering the risk of diabetes and heart diseases.

Apart from regulating our body processes, food also protects us from various infections, diseases and injuries.

For example consumption of vitamin A & vitamin C rich food help in building resistance in the body to fight against invading organisms

3.2.2 Psychological Functions of Food

The second major function of food is psychological function. Food also satisfies certain psychological needs of human beings. Foods indirectly helps to provide a sense of security, love and acceptance.

Every one grows in a particular culture with its own unique food habits. The person begins to associate the food habits and foods commonly consumed as it gives a sense of security and satiety. Even a nutritionally balanced meal may not be satisfying to the individual, if food included is unfamiliar or distasteful.

3.2.3 Social Functions of Food

Food is also a symbol of social life. When a meal is shared with anyone else, the acceptance of friendship and respect for that person are expressed.

Earlier only persons enjoying equal status in society ate together. A person would never share a meal with someone inferior to him in social terms.

Food is a medium through which happiness is expressed. For example feasts are given at specific states of life such as birthday, marriage etc. Sweets are also distributed and exchanged to mark certain auspicious occasions like festivals. Such gatherings bring people together and help to strengthen mutual friendship.

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